

Hebrew Vowel Marks (Niqqud) — Handy-Dandy One-Sheet

Name it • say its name • know its sound • know what it does to the consonant

Mark	Name	Say the name	Sound	What it does
	Patach	pah-TAKH	ah	Adds a short 'ah' vowel to the consonant.
	Qamatz	kah-MAHTZ	ah	Usually adds an 'ah' vowel to the consonant.
	Segol	seh-GOHL	eh	Adds an 'eh' sound, like e in 'bed'.
	Tsere	tsay-RAY	ay / eh	Adds a long e-type sound; often like 'ay'.
	Hiriq	hee-REEK	ee	Adds 'ee', like 'see'.
	Holam	kho-LAHM	oh	Adds 'oh', like 'go'.
	Qibbutz / Kubutz	kee-BOOTS	oo	Adds 'oo', like 'food'.
	Shuruk	shoo-ROOK	oo	Vav + dot; makes an 'oo' vowel.
	Sheva	sheh-VAH	short / silent	May be a very short vowel or no vowel.
	Hatef Patach	khah-TEF pah-TAKH	reduced ah	A quick/reduced 'ah' vowel.
	Hatef Segol	khah-TEF seh-GOHL	reduced eh	A quick/reduced 'eh' vowel; seen in Elohim.
	Hatef Qamatz	khah-TEF kah-MAHTZ	reduced oh	A quick/reduced 'oh' vowel.

Dots that can change the consonant

Dagesh — dot INSIDE a consonant

Say: dah-GESH

 = B  = V  = P  = F

A dagesh can also strengthen/double a consonant.
Later: the begadkephat letters can involve dagesh-related sound changes.
We'll add each new contrast here as it appears in Genesis.

Shin / Sin dot — dot ABOVE Shin

The dot's SIDE tells you which sound to make.

 
RIGHT dot = SH LEFT dot = S